

ADOBE PHOTOSHOP CS3



The king of all image-editing software—Adobe Photoshop—has now been rejuvenated as Photoshop CS3! It's faster and more feature-packed than before! We go through the best of the newly-added features and how you can use them to make an impression through your work.

Big Toolbar... Small Toolbar!

Almost all computer graphics creation tools—be it image editors or 3D modelling software—can have millions of toolbars and menus, which often crowd your workspace. The new Photoshop CS3 allows you to minimise the toolbars to a more compact layout.

The toolbar on the left and the docks to the right, which contain the history, histogram, layers, etc., have this feature. Click on the title bar of the toolbar on the left and it will toggle between a wider and vertically-expanded mode.

Similarly, click the title bar of the docks on the right and they will minimise to a compact bar. You can still access all the features in the docks, but they are hidden automatically whenever you move focus away from them.

Additionally, use [Tab] to hide all the palettes, and hold your mouse cursor at the edge of the screen to un-hide them. Once you're done, they'll go back into the edge of your screen, leaving you with your image.

Creating HDR Images

HDR (High Dynamic Range) in photography is a technique to display a larger range of light intensities than can be captured in a single camera shot. Start with taking the same shot at different shutter speeds to get multiple exposures. When you have your images ready, Photoshop CS3 can put them all together and create an HDR image.

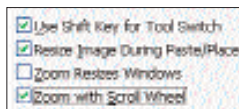
To create HDR images, go to **File > Automate > Merge to HDR**. Click **Browse** and select the files you want to make the HDR image out of. If you have a folder with the images, you can also choose that instead of separate files. Click **OK**, and Photoshop CS3 will process the images before displaying a window. This window lets you set the white point for the image. When you are satisfied with the results, click **OK**.

Creating Multiple Exposures For A Single Image

If you haven't taken multiple photos, you can still get yourself an HDR image using the **Exposure** filter. This simulates multiple exposures and can be used to get somewhat decent results in creating HDR images. Go to **Image > Adjustments > Exposure**. Alter the levels and click on **OK**. Save the file and make a couple of variations. Use these images to create HDR images as explained in the previous tip.

Zoom With The Scroll Wheel

If you want to zoom into your image, you could hold down [Alt] and use the scroll wheel, but this can get inconvenient, especially if you use [Space] immediately after to pan around your image—the window's [Alt] + [Space] menu comes up! Photoshop CS3 does let you use the scroll wheel for zooming, but it's not enabled by default. Go to **Edit > Preferences > General** and check the box against **Zoom with Scroll Wheel**. Click **OK**.



Access to the zoom function is easy with the mouse scroll

Refining selection edges

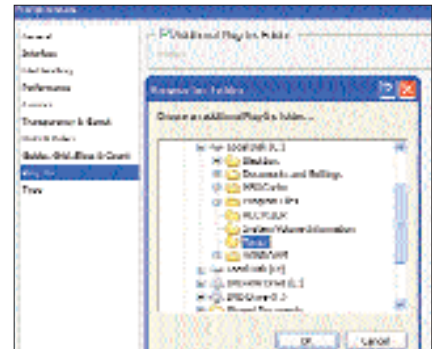
Selections made aren't always refined and smooth as you'd want them to be. Photoshop's selection tool now has a new feature called **Refine Edge**. By allowing you to alter settings for selection after it is made, much better control over the edges of the selection is made available.

Make a selection like you normally would with any of the selection tools—Marquee, Quick Selection, Lasso, etc. On

the **Options** bar on top, click the **Refine Edges** button. The area outside your selection will fade out, and you can make changes to parameters such as **Smoothness**, **Feather**, and **Contrast** to get the result you need.

Adding Plugins To Photoshop

Plugins are usually written by third-party developers to allow programs to extend their capabilities. You can find Photoshop plugins at

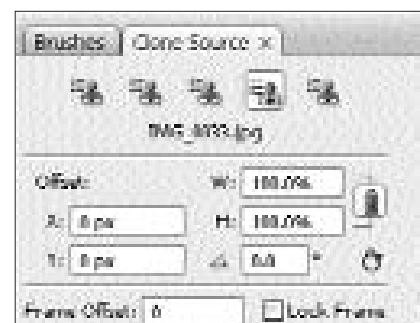


You can access third-party plugins in a separate folder from Photoshop

www.adobe.com/products/plugins/photoshop.

You can add a separate folder to have Photoshop automatically pick up plugins from if you have put them there. This also helps when the time comes to uninstall a plugin you don't care too much for. Go to **Edit > Preferences > Plug-Ins**, and check the box against **Additional Plug-Ins Folder**. Navigate to the folder you want to use and save your preferences.

Using The New Advanced Clone Tool



The clone tool in CS3 allows multiple clone sources

Do not mistake the **Clone Stamp** tool in CS3 to be just like the one in the earlier versions. This new version allows you set five different clone sources so you don't have to go selecting the source over and over again.

First, click the **Clone Stamp Tool** from the left toolbar. Click on the **Stamp Source** dock to the right (its icon is similar to the **Clone Stamp** icon).